the Jamuna River, XXXIII Corps (HQ Siliguri; 20 Mountain Division, later joined by 71 Mountain Brigade and 340 Mountain Brigade Group) was to advance as far as Bogra. In the western sector, south and west of the Padma, II Corps (HQ Krishnanagar; 4 Mountain and 9 Infantry divisions) was to capture Jessore and Jhenida. East of the Meghna River, IV Corps (HQ Teliamura; 8, 23 and 57 Mountain divisions) was to occupy Chandpur, Dhaudkandi and Ashuganj. In the northern sector, east of the Jamuna and west of the Meghna, 101 Communication Zone (HQ Tura; 95 Infantry Brigade, later joined by 167 Infantry Brigade) was to attack along the Jamalpur–Tangail axis.

As cross-border operations escalated, two important battles took place: II Corps launched an offensive on 12 November to capture Boyra on the Calcutta–Jessore axis and made considerable headway, defeating a Pakistani counter-attack on 19 November; and XXXIII Corps fought a fierce battle during 22–24 November when 20 Mountain Division's 202 Mountain Brigade was unable to capture Hilli. In late November, Indian forces were authorized to mount a full-scale attack on East Pakistan on 4 December. On 3 December, the Pakistan Air Force pre-emptively launched Operation *Chengiz Khan* against IAF bases in the west in order to relieve the pressure on East Pakistan. The main action was, however, to take place in the east.